service are denied on flimsy grounds even during the warranty period. Customer care service is likely to be rendered the shorter warranty period only for select few items which the manufacturers know pretty well that they do not get damaged during such period .Warranty service may not be extended to many parts/components of the product sold. Thus consumers may be charged exorbitant charges in the name of repair costs.

8. Unsuitability of Products

The product quality, durability and suitability may come under the category of product fitness. What is claimed by the product advertiser must correspond to the products sold. But in actual practice, it is not so. Items unsuitable for human consumption are sold in the market. Some items marked as "unbreakable" break while using them. Battery having a label 'leak proof" is more likely to leak. In all these eventualities users/ consumers have to bear the consequences while producers/manufacturers escape utilising the loopholes in the legal system.

9. False Advertisements

The main purpose of advertisement is to educate the consuming public and customers of various aspects of the products/ service. In reality, advertisements convey very little information about the product. Many times it makes false representation about the quality, price, grade, composition, utility guaranteed, performance etc. Consumers who buy the products on the faith of claims made in advertisements are cheated.

Thus consumerism has emerged and evolved out of outcome of sufferings and exploitation of consumers, whose sole aim is to secure protection from commercial terrorism and exploitative practices and thereby safeguarding their interest by establishing the rights and powers against producers and sellers.

16.03 Meaning and Definition of Consumerism

It is the social force protecting the consumer and aiding the consumer. In other words, it is an organised effort to fight against the unfair marketing practices with a view to secure consumer protection. Consumerism is the society's attempt to bring back the balance in the exchange between the buyers and sellers as the strength of power is normally in favour of sellers rather than buyers.

The term consumerism came into existence in the early 1960s when it was coined by the business community in the western world particularly in America. It is the social force designed to protect the interest of consumers by organising the consumers to bring pressure on the business community to ensure protection.

Producers, sellers and service providers give importance to the consumers. In a sense every one of us is a consumer. It may be individuals, families and institutions. They consume a variety of products and avail a number of services almost every day. You buy textbooks, notebooks, pen and other stationery items for your studies. Sometimes one–quire notebooks you buy do not contain 192 pages and the pencil is not of a good quality. Have you not been dissatisfied and heated over these when you have paid a fair price? Thus, a consumer is one who consumes goods manufactured and sold by others

The term consumerism was first coined by businessmen in the mid 1960s as they thought consumer movement as another "ism" like socialism and communism threatening capitalism.

"Consumerism is an attempt to enhance the rights and powers by buyers in relation to sellers"

-L. Massie

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